

COMPLETE PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT ROADMAP

PHASE 1 — Project Setup

Goal

Create clean professional backend architecture.

Milestone 1.1 — Setup Environment

Tasks

Install

```
pip install django djangorestframework pillow psycopg2-binary
```

Create Project

```
django-admin startproject config .
```

Create Apps

```
python manage.py startapp accounts  
python manage.py startapp profiles  
python manage.py startapp projects  
python manage.py startapp proposals  
python manage.py startapp reviews  
python manage.py startapp categories  
python manage.py startapp core
```

Add Apps to INSTALLED_APPS

```
INSTALLED_APPS = [  
    ...  
    'rest_framework',  
  
    'accounts',  
    'profiles',  
    'projects',  
    'proposals',  
    'reviews',  
    'categories',  
    'core',  
]
```

Milestone 1.2 — Configure Static & Media

settings.py

```
STATIC_URL = 'static/'  
STATICFILES_DIRS = [BASE_DIR / 'static']  
  
MEDIA_URL = 'media/'  
MEDIA_ROOT = BASE_DIR / 'media'
```

Milestone 1.3 — Create Base Templates

Folder Structure

```
templates/  
    base.html  
    navbar.html  
    footer.html
```

PHASE 2 — Authentication System

This is VERY important.

Milestone 2.1 — Custom User Model

Why?

Professional projects usually use custom users.

accounts/models.py

```
from django.contrib.auth.models import AbstractUser
from django.db import models
```

```
class User(AbstractUser):
```

```
    ROLE_CHOICES = (
        ('client', 'Client'),
        ('freelancer', 'Freelancer'),
    )
```

```
    role = models.CharField(max_length=20, choices=ROLE_CHOICES)
    is_verified = models.BooleanField(default=False)
```

settings.py

```
AUTH_USER_MODEL = 'accounts.User'
```

Milestone 2.2 — Registration

Features

- Name
- Email

- Password
 - Role selection
-

Learn

- Django forms
 - ModelForm
 - Password hashing
-

Milestone 2.3 — Login & Logout

Use Django authentication system.

Milestone 2.4 — Email Verification

Learn

- Django token generator
 - send_mail()
 - Email backend
-

Flow

Register



Email Sent



User clicks link



Account activated

PHASE 3 — User Profile System

Milestone 3.1 — Profile Model

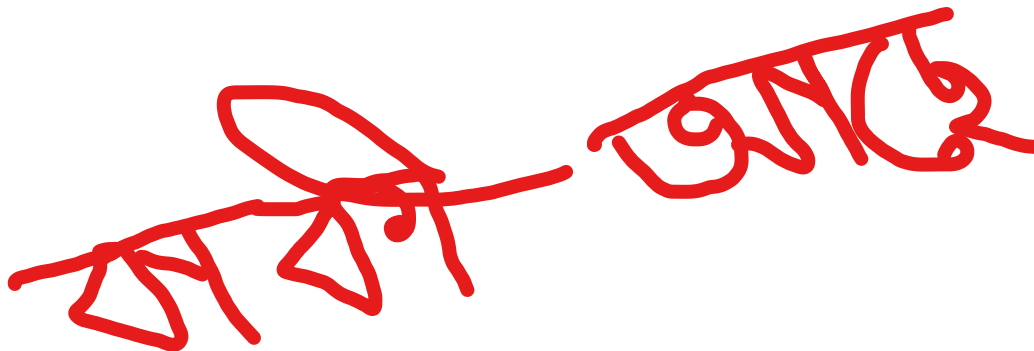
profiles/models.py

```
class Profile(models.Model):  
  
    user = models.OneToOneField(User,on_delete=models.CASCADE)  
  
    image = models.ImageField(upload_to='profiles/')  
    bio = models.TextField()  
  
    skills = models.TextField()  
  
    github = models.URLField(blank=True)  
    linkedin = models.URLField(blank=True)
```

Milestone 3.2 — Profile Page

Features

- Profile image
- Skills
- Bio
- Social links
- Applied jobs history



PHASE 4 — Categories System

Milestone 4.1 — Category Model

```
class Category(models.Model):  
    name = models.CharField(max_length=100)
```

PHASE 5 — Project System

This is the CORE feature.

Milestone 5.1 — Project Model

projects/models.py

```
class Project(models.Model):  
  
    client = models.ForeignKey(User,on_delete=models.CASCADE)  
  
    category = models.ForeignKey(Category,on_delete=models.CASCADE)  
  
    title = models.CharField(max_length=200)  
  
    description = models.TextField()  
  
    budget = models.DecimalField(max_digits=10,decimal_places=2)  
  
    deadline = models.DateField()  
  
    created_at = models.DateTimeField(auto_now_add=True)
```

Milestone 5.2 — Create Project

Client Features

- Add project

- Edit project
 - Delete project
-

Milestone 5.3 — Project Listing

Features

- All projects
 - Responsive cards
 - Budget
 - Deadline
 - Client info
-

Milestone 5.4 — Filtering

Filters

- Category
 - Budget sorting
 - Search by title
-

Learn

- Query parameters
 - Django ORM filtering
-

Milestone 5.5 — Project Details Page

Features

- Full description
 - Client profile
 - Proposal form
 - Related projects
-

PHASE 6 — Proposal System

VERY IMPORTANT.

Milestone 6.1 — Proposal Model

```
class Proposal(models.Model):
```

```
    STATUS_CHOICES = (  
        ('pending','Pending'),  
        ('accepted','Accepted'),  
        ('rejected','Rejected'),  
    )
```

```
    project = models.ForeignKey(Project,on_delete=models.CASCADE)
```

```
    freelancer = models.ForeignKey(User,on_delete=models.CASCADE)
```

```
    cover_letter = models.TextField()
```

```
    bid_amount = models.DecimalField(max_digits=10,decimal_places=2)
```

```
    created_at = models.DateTimeField(auto_now_add=True)
```

```
    status = models.CharField(max_length=20,choices=STATUS_CHOICES,default='pending')
```

Milestone 6.2 — Apply to Project

Features

- Cover letter textarea
 - Bid amount
 - Apply button
-

Milestone 6.3 — Client Proposal Dashboard

Client can:

- View all proposals
 - Accept proposal
 - Reject proposal
-

PHASE 7 — Review & Rating System

Milestone 7.1 — Review Model

```
class Review(models.Model):
```

```
    project = models.ForeignKey(Project,on_delete=models.CASCADE)
```

```
    freelancer = models.ForeignKey(User,on_delete=models.CASCADE)
```

```
    client =  
models.ForeignKey(User,on_delete=models.CASCADE,related_name='client_reviews')
```

```
    rating = models.IntegerField()
```

```
    comment = models.TextField()
```

PHASE 8 — Frontend Design

Use Bootstrap first.

Recommended Pages

Public

- Home
 - About
 - Project list
 - Login
 - Register
-

Client Dashboard

- My projects
 - Create project
 - Received proposals
-

Freelancer Dashboard

- Applied projects
 - Profile
 - Reviews
-

RESPONSIVE UI STRUCTURE

Navbar

- Logo
- Browse Projects

- Login/Register
 - Profile dropdown
-

Home Hero Section

- Big heading
 - Search bar
 - CTA buttons
-

Project Card

Project Title

Budget

Deadline

Category

Apply Button

PHASE 9 — Django REST Framework

Now make it professional.

Milestone 9.1 — Build APIs

APIs

- Auth API
 - Project API
 - Proposal API
 - Review API
-

Example

serializers.py

```
class ProjectSerializer(serializers.ModelSerializer):
```

```
    class Meta:
        model = Project
        fields = '__all__'
```

ViewSet

```
class ProjectViewSet(viewsets.ModelViewSet):
    queryset = Project.objects.all()
    serializer_class = ProjectSerializer
```

URLs

```
router = DefaultRouter()

router.register('projects', ProjectViewSet)

urlpatterns = router.urls
```

PHASE 10 — Professional Features

These make your resume stronger.

Add These

1. Pagination

PageNumberPagination

2. Search

SearchFilter

3. Ordering

OrderingFilter

4. Permissions

IsAuthenticated

5. JWT Authentication

Use:

djangorestframework-simplejwt

6. Image Upload

- User avatars
 - Project attachments
-

PHASE 11 — Deployment

Backend Deployment

Render

Deploy:

- Django backend
 - PostgreSQL database
-

Frontend Deployment

Netlify

Deploy:

- HTML/CSS/JS frontend
-

PHASE 12 — Resume-Level Improvements

These matter a LOT.

Add README

Include

- Features
 - Tech stack
 - Installation
 - API endpoints
 - Screenshots
-

Add Screenshots

Include:

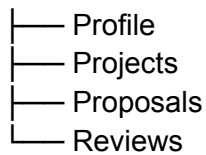
- Home page
 - Dashboard
 - Project details
 - Proposal system
-

Add ER Diagram

Professional touch.

Suggested Database Relationships

User



Project

